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EXCELLENCE
ROOTED
IN VALUES

THE
CHEMISTRY
OF SUCCESS

THE STORY OF
UMESH ANAND
MANAGING DIRECTOR OF
HPL ADDITIVES LIMITED

A LEGACY
FORGED IN
CHEMISTRY AND COMMITMENT

UMESH ANAND



FORGED

A LEGACY

IN CHEMISTRY AND COMMITMENT

CEO Magazine: Can you tell us about the origins of HPL Additives and its journey so far?

Umesh Anand: HPL Additives traces its roots back to 1964, when it was founded by the visionary scientist-entrepreneur, Late Mr. Harcharan Singh. What began as a modest, garage-based initiative gradually evolved into a globally respected name in the specialty chemicals industry. The company was later incorporated as a limited entity in 1976, marking an important step in its structured growth.

The founding vision was centered on creating indigenous solutions for India at a time when dependence on imports was significant. Starting with blowing agents, the company steadily expanded into polymer additives and specialty chemicals. The early years were not easy—we had to build both technical capability and credibility in a market that was skeptical about Indian

manufacturing. However, these challenges shaped our culture, making us disciplined, resilient, and deeply committed to quality.

CEO Magazine: How has HPL Additives expanded its presence globally?

Umesh Anand: Today, HPL Additives has established itself as a truly transnational organization. While our manufacturing strength lies in India, we have strategically built distribution networks across Europe and the United States. This allows us to deliver the same level of efficiency and responsiveness to our global customers as we do domestically.

A key factor in this expansion has been our shift from being merely a manufacturer to becoming a solutions-driven partner. We focus on understanding customer requirements in depth and delivering tailored solutions. This approach has strengthened our relationships and enabled

us to compete effectively in international markets.

CEO Magazine: What is the RAPID framework, and how does it contribute to your success?

Umesh Anand: The RAPID framework represents our integrated and agile way of working. It brings together market intelligence, technical expertise, and operational execution into one cohesive system. Our Product Application & Technical Support (PATS) team works closely with our R&D division to convert customer needs into practical solutions.

This alignment ensures that we are not only responsive but also consistent in our delivery. By integrating manufacturing, quality, and project support, we can adapt quickly to changing market demands while maintaining high standards. The RAPID framework essentially enables us to translate insight into impact.



CEO Magazine: How does HPL approach innovation and research?

Umesh Anand: At HPL, innovation goes beyond the laboratory—it is embedded in everything we do. We view research and development through the dual lenses of competitiveness and sustainability. We focus heavily on process optimization and efficiency. Our R&D efforts are benchmark-driven, ensuring that we remain relevant in an increasingly competitive environment. Ultimately, innovation

must create value—for our customers and for the industry.

My goal is not just to innovate but to ensure that innovation leads to real, measurable outcomes. Innovation, for me, must enhance productivity, reduce costs, and align with global benchmarks.

CEO Magazine: What role does sustainability play in your organization?

Umesh Anand: Sustainability is a

core part of our business philosophy, not an optional initiative. Our ESG strategy is deeply embedded in our operations. On the environmental front, we have taken concrete steps to reduce emissions and improve efficiency, which is reflected in our CDP disclosure rating.

On the social side, the HPL Foundation focuses on education and healthcare initiatives, ensuring that our growth contributes to society. We believe that responsible business means creating value not just for stakeholders, but for the community as well. Sustainability, for us, is practical, measurable, and integral to our long-term vision.

“We do not equate growth with scale alone; we focus on continuous refinement.”

CEO Magazine: What differentiates HPL Additives in a competitive market?

Umesh Anand: Our key strength lies in combining technical depth with a versatile product portfolio. We do not simply offer products—we build partnerships. By understanding the specific needs of our customers, whether it is performance or regulatory compliance, we provide solutions that are tailored and effective.

This approach transforms our relationships into long-term collaborations. Additionally, my commitment to both competitiveness and sustainability and to ensure that HPL remains relevant in a rapidly evolving industry. These principles have

helped us establish a strong and lasting presence globally.

CEO Magazine: How do you see the current landscape of the specialty chemicals industry?

Umesh Anand: The industry is at an interesting stage, where significant growth opportunities coexist with rising competition. The ongoing realignment of global supply chains presents a major opportunity for India. However, only those companies that can combine quality, technical expertise, and cost efficiency will truly benefit.

The focus today must be on building capabilities that meet global standards while remaining competitive. Companies that can achieve this balance will be well-positioned for long-term success.

CEO Magazine: What is your long-term vision for HPL Additives?

Umesh Anand: My vision is to build an enduring institution—one that stands strong over time and adapts to changing market dynamics. We do not equate growth with scale alone. Instead, we focus on continuous refinement of our core businesses.

My aim to strengthen our technological capabilities, improve operational excellence, and remain committed to sustainability. The goal is to evolve while staying rooted in our foundational values. This is what will ensure our relevance and resilience in the years to come.

CEO Magazine: What advice would you give to emerging entrepreneurs?

Umesh Anand: My advice would be to focus on long-term sustainability rather than short-term expansion. In any industry, reliability is as important as innovation. Building trust takes time, and it should be a priority.

At the same time, businesses must remain agile and open to continuous improvement. The most successful organizations are those that balance entrepreneurial energy with institutional discipline. This combination enables growth that is both meaningful and sustainable.

CEO Magazine: Any closing message for your stakeholders and partners?

Umesh Anand: I would like to express my sincere gratitude to all our stakeholders, customers, and the entire HPL team. Their trust and support have been instrumental in our journey.

I remain committed to delivering uncompromising quality and creating lasting value. As I look ahead, I do so with confidence and humility, fully aware of the responsibility that comes with the trust placed in me. My commitment to excellence and integrity will continue to guide us forward.

“The future belongs to companies that can balance quality with competitiveness. India has a significant opportunity to become a stronger global specialty chemicals hub.”

